

Connecting MySQL Workbench through the Web server

Overview

To improve security we should connect to all our MySQL instances by first SSHing into the webserver, and then connecting from there to the MySQL server via port 3306. If you connect using the MySQL client, simply SSH in to the web server first and then connect as per normal. If you use MySQL Workbench follow the instructions below. This has two benefits:

1. We can lock down the MySQL servers completely from external access
2. The MySQL traffic from our office or homes is encrypted over the internet

Configuration

To configure each connection, you will need the following information.

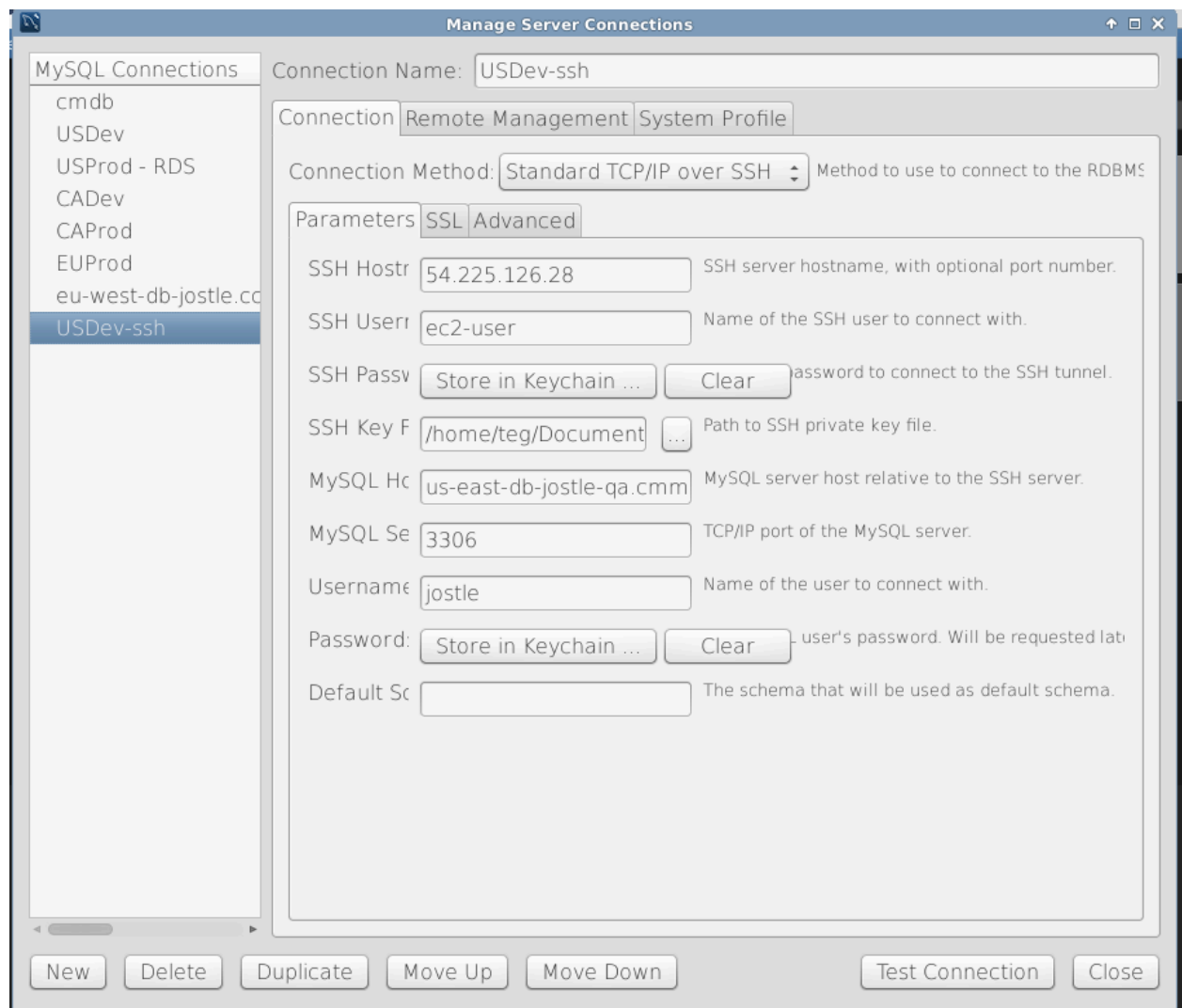
1. Web server IP (Internal and external for CA)
2. Web server SSH username (either ec2-user or toor)
3. Web server SSH key
4. RDS instance name or MySQL server IP
5. Database username (jostle)
6. Database Password

Here is how to configure MySQL workbench to connect to the databases relaying through the web servers.

1. Create a new connection in MySQL Workbench
2. Enter the connection name - this can be anything you want
3. On the Connection tab change the Connection method to "Standard TCP/IP over SSH"
4. On the Parameters tab, enter the Web server's IP in the SSH Hostname field
5. Enter the Web server SSH username in the SSH Username field
6. Click the button to navigate to your SSH key on your local disk for the SSH Key File field
7. Add the RDS or MySQL server IP address in the MySQL Host field
8. Add the Database username in the Username field

At this point you should be able to hit "Test connection" and get good results.

This shows the settings for the US Dev RDS instance.



And here is an example of connecting to CA Dev DB:

MySQL Connections

cldb

USProd - RDS

CAProd

EUProd

eu-west-db-jostle.co

USDev-ssh

CADev-ssh

Connection Name: CADev-ssh

Connection

Remote Management

System Profile

Connection Method: Standard TCP/IP over SSH Method to use to connect to the RDBMS

Parameters

SSL

Advanced

SSH Host: 76.74.203.101 SSH server hostname, with optional port number.

SSH User: toor Name of the SSH user to connect with.

SSH Passw:

Store in Keychain ...

Clear

 Password to connect to the SSH tunnel.

SSH Key F: /home/teg/Document ... Path to SSH private key file.

MySQL Host: 10.10.1.100 MySQL server host relative to the SSH server.

MySQL Port: 3306 TCP/IP port of the MySQL server.

Username: jostle Name of the user to connect with.

Password:

Store in Keychain ...

Clear

 user's password. Will be requested later.

Default Schema: The schema that will be used as default schema.

New

Delete

Duplicate

Move Up

Move Down

Test Connection

Close